



Food Waste

Why do we throw so much away?

A third of the world's food is never eaten. The real cost is much bigger.



Listen to the article

Scan the QR code or visit the link.



Good food is thrown away every day, while millions of people go hungry.

WARM-UP

Talk about the questions with a partner.

1. What food do you throw away most often at home?
2. Who should fix this problem: shops, or people at home?

USEFUL LANGUAGE

We often throw away...

I think... should...

Tonight, in kitchens all over the world, the same thing will happen. Some bread, a few vegetables, half a plate of dinner — into the bin. It feels like nothing. But do this in a billion homes, every day, and it becomes one of the biggest problems on the planet. About a third of all the food we grow is never eaten.

The numbers are hard to imagine. Every year, people throw away about 1.3 billion tons of food. At the same time, millions of people do not have enough to eat. Milk and vegetables stay **fresh** for only a few days, and they **spoil** fast. But in rich countries, most of the **waste** happens at home.

The problem is bigger than the bin. When old food sits in a landfill, it makes a gas that is very bad for the planet. If food waste was a country, it would be the third biggest polluter in the world. We also throw away the water and the land that grew it. One small apple needs about 125 liters of water.

But this is a problem we can all help with. Some shops now sell **extra** food at a low price. Restaurants give their food away. Families make a plan before they shop, and they remember that an ugly vegetable is still **edible**.

If a third of our food goes in the bin, what could change if each of us wasted a little less?

VOCABULARY

A. Match the words (1–5) with the meanings (A–E).

- | | | |
|-----------|---|--|
| 1. waste | — | A. new, and not old |
| 2. fresh | — | B. more than you need |
| 3. spoil | — | C. safe to eat |
| 4. extra | — | D. to throw away something you could use |
| 5. edible | — | E. to go bad, so you cannot eat it |

TRUE OR FALSE

Read the sentences. Circle T (True) or F (False).

- | | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1. The article says we eat all the food we grow. | T | F |
| 2. Milk and vegetables stay fresh for only a few days. | T | F |
| 3. In rich countries, most food waste happens on farms. | T | F |
| 4. Old food in a landfill makes a gas that is bad for the planet. | T | F |
| 5. Some shops sell extra food at a low price. | T | F |

DISCUSSION

USEFUL LANGUAGE I think... · For me... · because... · It depends.

- 1 Do you throw away much food at home? What kind?
- 2 What did your family teach you about wasting food?
- 3 Why do you think rich countries waste more food?
- 4 Should shops be allowed to throw away food that is still good?
- 5 Is it ever OK to waste food? When?



01 CRITICAL THINKING

THE FRIDGE TEST

Five things in your fridge tonight. Do you eat them, or throw them away?

Choose alone first. Mark every line **EAT**, **NOT SURE** or **THROW**. Then compare in your group.

WHAT IS IN THE FRIDGE	THINK ABOUT THIS	EAT	NOT SURE	THROW
Yogurt, two days after the date.	The date says "best before," not "dangerous."	☐	☐	☐
Bread with mold on one slice.	You can see some mold. You cannot see all of it.	☐	☐	☐
An apple with a big brown mark.	The mark is ugly, but the rest is fine.	☐	☐	☐
Milk one day over. It smells normal.	Your nose knows more than the label does.	☐	☐	☐
Rice that sat on the counter all night.	It looks fine. Warm rice can still make people sick.	☐	☐	☐

YOUR TOTAL Food you would throw away: _____ of 5 Food that was really not safe: _____

- DISCUSS**
- 1 Are you throwing away the food, or the date on the label?
 - 2 Compare with another group. Who threw away the most? Would your grandparents agree?

02 LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

USE THE LANGUAGE

Complete the sentences with a word from the box.

edible extra fresh spoil waste

- 1 Milk and salad _____ very quickly in summer.
- 2 Please do not _____ food that is still good.
- 3 We bought _____ bread, so we can freeze some.
- 4 An ugly apple is still _____.
- 5 This fish is very _____. It came in this morning.

03 SPEAKING CHALLENGE

ROLE • TASK • PRESENT

Work in small groups. Follow the three steps.

ROLE You work in a small café. Every night you throw food away.

TASK Choose two ways to waste less. Decide who pays for each one.

PRESENT Tell the class your two ideas and say why they will work.

USEFUL LANGUAGE

Our first idea is... · We can...

This will work because... · We think... should pay.

04 WRITING

YOUR OPINION

Should shops be allowed to throw away food that is still good?

Write 60–100 words. Use words from the article.

USEFUL LANGUAGE

I think shops should... · The first reason is... · For example,... · But... · So I think...